A If a phrase in bold is correct, put a tick. If it is incorrect, rewrite it correctly.

1 Hardly **I had sat down** when the doorbell rang. .....
2 Scarcely **had Julian finished** writing when the teacher told the students to put their pens down.
.....
3 We had barely set off on our journey when **the kids started** asking when we would get there.
.....
4 No sooner **the government changes** the tax laws than businesses find a way around them.
.....
5 Scarcely **they had finished** painting the house when it started to rain. .....
6 Hardly **the new computer system had been installed** when it started to go wrong.
.....
7 It's true that no sooner **we had started** eating than we realised we had forgotten the potatoes.
.....
8 Barely had the politician started to speak when **began the crowd** to boo.
.....
9 Hardly **the new park was finished** when vandals destroyed the flowerbeds.
.....
10 Scarcely **Keith had arrived** in Argentina when he was arrested. .....

B Complete using the words and phrases in the box.

at no point • in no way • little • never • not • not only only after • on no account • rarely • under no circumstances

1 ..... were the security guards to blame for what happened.
2 ..... once did the old woman thank me for helping her.
3 ..... seeing the doctor was Theresa allowed to leave hospital.
4 ..... will passengers be allowed to carry more than 6 kg of hand luggage.
5 ..... were you late, but you also forgot to bring the correct documents.
6 ..... during the meeting did anyone mention that the managing director was planning to leave.
7 ..... did the passengers know that the driver was really an undercover police officer.
8 ..... do you meet anyone as charming as Mr Beeching.
9 ..... should unaccompanied children be allowed to enter the area.
10 ..... before has the company found itself facing such stiff competition.

C Complete using the words in bold with the verb in the correct form.

1 Not until the area is made safe ..... . (**construction / can continue**)
2 In no way ..... (**the announcement / affect**) how strongly we felt about the situation.
3 Seldom ..... (**you / see**) a vintage car in quite such good condition these days.
4 Not only ..... (**Jerry / forget**) my birthday, but he also forgot our wedding anniversary.
5 At no time ..... (**I / ask**) my opinion on the subject.

6 Only when ..... (**I / checked**) the ticket again did I realise that I had won first prize!
7 Little ..... (**Caroline / realise**) that I had a big surprise planned for her.
8 Under no circumstances ..... (**you / should sign**) a contract you haven't read thoroughly.
9 At no stage ..... (**it / appear**) likely that Wilkinson would win the championship.
10 Only if the weather is clear ..... (**the space shuttle / will allow**) to launch.

D **Complete using a verb from the box in the correct form. Try to use each verb at least once.**

appear • be • come • go • lie • sit • stand

Neighbourhood noise

'There (**1**) ..... our new neighbour now,' said Joe. I looked up and coming along the path (**2**) ..... a short, fat man. On his head (**3**) ..... a bright red baseball cap. He ignored us and went into the house next door. We waited a moment. From an upstairs window (**4**) ..... the sound of loud rock music. Joe sighed.
'Every day for the past week has been the same,' he said. 'Well, today's going to be different.' In his hand (**5**) ..... a letter from the council. 'This'll stop him,' he said.
We went next door and knocked. After a moment, the door opened and the music suddenly got louder. There (**6**) ..... a little old woman, looking up at us, smiling. On the sofa behind her (**7**) ..... a fat old cat.
'Erm ... we've come about the noise,' mumbled Joe, confused at finding the old woman.
'Eh?' she said.
'About the noise. I've got a letter from the council,' shouted Joe. Suddenly, in the doorway (**8**) ..... the same fat man I had seen earlier.
'She's quite deaf. That's why she plays her music so loud. Can I help you?'
Joe looked at the little old woman. 'Er ... no. No. That's okay.' He screwed the letter up and put it into his pocket.

E **Circle the correct phrase. If both are correct, circle both.**

1 Dave doesn't really trust Ian, and I have to say that neither **I do / do I**.
2 Such a valuable painting **it is / is it** that the public are not allowed to get close to it.
3 So **we could / could we** watch TV while we ate, we moved the television onto the balcony.
4 My dad's never been abroad, and nor **my mum has / has my mum**.
5 Such **the media interest was / was the media interest** in the wedding that there were over a dozen photographers.
6 It's been a hard season for the team, as **last season was / was last season**.
7 Russia is a country with vast natural resources, and so **China is / is China**.
8 We in this country spend more per person on fuel than **the French do / do the French**.
9 The Minister was forced to resign, such **the pressure was / was the pressure** on her.
10 So nervous **he was / was he** that I was almost certain he was lying.

F **Rewrite the sentences, starting with the words given.**

1 The window was broken by a cricket ball.
It .....

2 I will never forget the day I heard I'd got into my chosen university.
The day on .....

3 Glynn became a social worker to help people less fortunate than himself.
The reason .....

4 Getting through the summer without getting injured was the only thing the athlete wanted.
All .....

5 The driver didn't see the motorcyclist.
What happened .....

6 Christopher Columbus discovered America.
The person .....

7 Seeing Patricia cry like that made me feel guilty.
What .....

8 What we had to do first was decide where to meet.
The first thing .....

9 There are lots of facilities where we go camping.
The place .....

10 Einstein proved that energy and mass are basically the same thing.
What .....

G **Write so, *such*, *too* or *enough* in each gap.**

1 It was ..... good a meal that we left the waiter quite a large tip.
2 It's becoming increasingly clear that there just aren't ..... people willing to buy our products online.
3 I'm quite enjoying my maths degree, but I just find statistics ..... boring!
4 Angela seemed to be having ..... a good time at the party that I decided not to tell her how late it was.
5 We've all been working ..... hard on the latest project the manager gave us a couple of extra days off.
6 I worry about my grandparents because they have ..... a lot of health problems.
7 It's ..... early to tell whether the business is going to succeed or not.
8 Set the alarm or we'll never wake up early ..... to catch the first train.
9 I never knew that Andrew had ..... few friends.
10 Everyone was surprised when Dan failed because he's ..... a good student.
11 A year after losing my job, I had ..... many debts that I was really beginning to panic.
12 I was hoping to have a word with Alan before he left, but it seems to be ..... late now.

H **Complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first sentence, using the word given. Do not change the word given. You must use between three and eight words, including the word given.**

1 I had to clear the spare room before I could start decorating. **cleared**
Only when ..... start decorating.

2 The phone rang again as soon as I put it down. **had**
Hardly ..... it rang again.

3 The Watsons moved to London and very soon after they decided to get divorced. **had**
No sooner ..... they decided to get divorced.

4 I had no idea the manager wanted to see me to fire me. **realise**
Little ..... the manager wanted to see me to fire me.

5 I was told about the website by Charlie. **who**
It ..... me about the website.

6 Buying a plane ticket at the last minute isn't often possible. **to**
Rarely ..... a plane ticket at the last minute.

7 They didn't ask me anything about my plans for the summer. **question**
Not ..... about my plans for the summer.

8 There is no situation in which we will allow the management to lower wages. **no**
Under ..... the management to lower wages.

I Choose the correct answer.

1 Not until we have no choice ..... the business down.
A close we
B we will close
C will we close
D we close

2 It was ..... a victory that even Smith's fans couldn't believe it.
A such surprising
B so surprising
C too surprising
D surprising enough

3 At no time ..... I was going to fail the exam.
A did I think
B thought I
C I thought
D was I thought

4 So ..... that they actually finished three weeks early.
A were the builders fast
B fast the builders were
C the builders were fast
D fast were the builders

5 Never ..... complete and utter rubbish!
A have I heard so
B I heard such
C did I hear so
D have I heard such

6 In no way ..... that people will be prevented from organising peaceful protests.
A this law means
B means this law
C does this law mean
D this law does mean

7 If you don't put the tent up ..... , it might blow away!
A too carefully
B so carefully
C such carefully
D carefully enough

8 No sooner ..... everyone started to gossip about him.
A had Mike left than
B did Mike leave when
C left Mike when
D Mike had left than

9 'I can't stand this hot weather!'
'No, ... Dreadful, isn't it?'
A so can't I
B neither can I
C so I can't
D nor I can

10 'We were at the *Rolling Stones* concert last weekend.'
'Were you? So .....!'
A I was
B was I being
C I was there
D was I

J Write one word in each gap.

Problems close to home

Rarely (**1**) ..... neighbours have the best of relationships for any length of time. Of course, some people become close friends, but only if there is a lot of give and take (**2**) ..... this possible. (**3**) ..... common are disputes between neighbours that there are many laws to cover arguments over noise, property and rubbish. Before things go (**4**) ..... far for the relationship to be saved, there are a few simple things you can do. The first is (**5**) ..... speak to your neighbour. You'd be amazed at how many arguments are avoided by (**6**) ..... a simple step. Not (**7**) ..... does it give you the chance to express your complaint, it (**8**) ..... gives your neighbour the chance to explain and, perhaps, take action.

Secondly, check your rights. On (**9**) ..... account should you do anything to damage your neighbours' property, or their overhanging trees if that's the problem, without knowing what your legal rights are. (**10**) ..... until you are sure you are acting within the law should you do anything. And remember – a little understanding can go a long way.